

OUTCOME ORIENTED

A planning process focusing on the experience of the user

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The objective of an outcome oriented planning approach is to outline *why we intend to deliver...* albeit a feature, a new product, a new UI, and even a new service flow.

This form of planning is well suited for an Agile based product team because the roadmap is dynamic based upon the defined outcomes. An outcome oriented roadmap is:

- focused on outcomes over output
- is evolving rather than static
- embraces learning over establishing certainty

By centering the product design conversation around outcomes, we become feature-agnostic and enable our team to use their expertise to explore the solutions that solve the unique needs of users.

Keeping the user at the forefront, each team member is tasked with representing the user, advocating for that user, and therefore maintain communication with that user.

This allows us to optimize for learning and for the team to use their expertise which provides a sense of purpose and leads to better product.

Outcome-based roadmaps provide

VISIBILITY

- while enabling the team to prioritize and plan based on value

CLARITY AND ALIGNMENT

- between sponsors, stakeholders and the product team

AUTONOMY AND EMPOWERMENT

- for product teams to solve problems, rather than implement solutions

SPACE FOR USER FEEDBACK

- in the product development process, with time allotted for learning and implementing changes

UNDERSTANDING THE VISION

The whole team, stakeholders included, need to agree upon and understand the experience desired for the users. This state captures the desired outcomes in a crafted narrative that is aspirational.

Complexity as well as technical constraints and unique business challenges are factored in later.

This narrative is a compelling scenario writing approach which grounds the brand, products, and features into the behavior of the personas being addressed.

STRATEGY

With a vision laid out the process now becomes distilling down that vision into the Now, the Near, and the Future.

Next it is important to callout:

- What do we need to do to realize this vision?
 - i.e. what research needs to be done
- What might be some challenges that we need to overcome?
 - i.e. technical, commercial, physical
- What initiatives will allow us to solve for those challenges?
 - i.e. growing trends in VUI, new data science models

ROADMAP

This is not a hard promise or release plan, but rather a high-level strategy for achievable outcomes broken down in any way desired; quarters, sub 3 months, half year, year.

it is recommended that this timetable be consistent across teams, for parity

Things to capture would be:

- Research-based feature ideas
- Feature improvements
- Performance and code quality improvements

BACKLOG

Nope, we can't get rid of this; however, to prevent the Backlog from becoming just another list, dedicated time should be spent by the team collectively reviewing the list.

This helps prevent it from becoming just another list.

APPENDIX (A)

Scenario writing created for the Aktana Command Center

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1oIn6n67decpejK4ntU2SYJBIY5bqzLJPDgrZh4A1eVw/edit?usp=sharing>

APPENDIX (B)

Example scenario writing created for NEO

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1optEHukpGWV0FqIEQxIIIltInqha8XIBvt92gImKbtM/edit?usp=sharing>

APPENDIX (C)

Do you have a good outcome oriented roadmap?

Pivotal blog post with 6 test elements to sure the roadmap is effective.

<https://content.pivotal.io/blog/do-you-have-a-good-outcome-oriented-roadmap>

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

EMPOWER USERS

- Building trust begins with meeting the users' outcomes while providing a sense of accomplishment.

DESIGN IS NOT AN ISLAND

- Design is the product of collaboration amongst all entities involved to define a problem, understand a problem, and solve a problem.

MINIMIZE THE PAIN

- People want what lies on the other side of their task, so the process of completing said task should be as simple and easy as possible.

ILLUMINATE A PATH TO COMPLETION

- Since the point of just about every task is a means to the outcome, make it abundantly clear how people can accomplish the desired outcome.

CONSIDER THE CONTEXT

- Products rarely exist in a vacuum. They are almost always part of a broader context (environment, audience, device, business), which informs how they'll be used.

ENSURE CONSISTENT COMMUNICATION

- Products broker conversations between customers and companies. Although an organization can have many groups taking part in these conversations (product, design, marketing, clinical, engineering, legal, business, etc.) a product needs to speak to its audience with one voice.